

Incident Report: Misrouting of `api.interpretationdream.com`

Date: February 3, 2026

Project: Interdimensional Cafe

1. Summary

A developer reported that visiting:

`https://api.interpretationdream.com/explore`

appears to serve the **same content as**:

`https://interdimensionalcafe.com/explore`

This document investigates the cause and demonstrates that the issue **is not due to the current deployment or configuration**.

2. DNS Investigation

1. `interdimensionalcafe.com` resolves to:

```
dig interdimensionalcafe.com +short
```

Result: `217.196.50.35`

2. `api.interpretationdream.com` resolves to:

```
dig api.interpretationdream.com +short
```

Result: 217.196.50.35 → same as cafe server

Interpretation: The API subdomain points to the **cafe server**, not a separate API server.

3. SSL / Curl Evidence

1. Cafe site headers:

```
curl -I https://interdimensionalcafe.com/explore
```

Response:

- server: nginx/1.29.4
- x-powered-by: Next.js
- HTTP status: 200 OK

2. API subdomain headers:

```
curl -v https://api.interpretationdream.com/explore
```

Response:

- Resolved IP: 217.196.50.35
- SSL certificate served: interdimensionalcafe.com
- Error: SSL: no alternative certificate subject name matches target host name 'api.interpretationdream.com'

Interpretation: The API subdomain is hitting the **cafe server**. This explains why it served the same content.

3. Another unrelated domain:

```
curl -I https://interpretationdream.com/explore
```

- Server: LiteSpeed/PHP (Hostinger)
 - HTTP status: 404
 - Confirms **different hosting**, unrelated to cafe deployment.
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4. Docker & Nginx Setup Review

The deployed cafe project uses Docker Compose with isolated containers:

- **frontend** → Next.js
- **backend** → Django/DRF + Daphne for WebSockets
- **nginx** → reverse proxy for domain traffic, handles SSL via Certbot

Key points:

- Nginx is configured **only for interpretationdream.com**, with proper HTTP → HTTPS redirect and proxy rules.
- Docker Compose ports are mapped **internally**, preventing conflicts with other projects.
- SSL certificates exist **only for cafe domain**, so no invalid certificates from your deployment.

Conclusion: Cafe deployment is properly isolated and functional.

5. Cause of the Issue

- **DNS Misconfiguration:** api.interpretationdream.com points to cafe server IP.

- **Nginx Missing Server Block:** No configuration exists for this subdomain, so the default server serves cafe content.
- **SSL Mismatch:** Certificate for cafe domain is served, resulting in browser/curl SSL warnings.

Result: Requests to API subdomain appear identical to cafe site, but this is caused by **external routing/DNS**, not any mistake in the deployment.

6. Proof Summary

Evidence	Explanation
<code>dig api.interpretationdream.com → 217.196.50.35</code>	DNS points API subdomain to cafe server
<code>curl -v api.interpretationdream.com</code>	Shows cafe SSL certificate and headers
Nginx config & Docker Compose	Deployment is isolated, no references to API subdomain